again and again caused too much 'damage' while other supporters felt that he had been a disappointment. In fact, the failure of the dharna was another factor given by students that showed that political protests did not work. In focus groups in Karachi there were students who had previously voted for MQM, but the rationale for such voting was based on their family's commitment to MQM, thereby continuing the tradition. There were those who also struggled with voting, MQM supporters who had voted for PTI but had already decided that they would vote for an independent, since PTI was a disappointment: *'Dil abhi bhee Mutaahida ka hai*[36] *but you just can't support them because things around you are such*'; '*I would vote because in my ilaaka bachpan sei hum MQM ko vote daaltei hain.*[37] *MQM is a progressive party. It has Muhajjir representation*'; '*Actually my grandma was an active MQM supporter and went to protests in the 70s. She says they used to be peaceful in the past but she does not vote for them anymore. She went through the 1990s and saw her friends getting killed and saw what MQM did*' (Focus Group, Private University[38]). In the focus groups held in Karachi and Lahore, the students in Karachi were more expressive of their political views, and more aware of broader provincial and national politics. In Lahore, the majority of supporters still belonged to the PML(N), while PTI had managed to gain the support of some. The PPP had least support among the students, as one observed *'Apna bhee nahi hai.*[39] *Will see what Bilawal does*' (Focus Group, Private University[40]).

Another exception was an active supporter of the Jamaat-e-Islami who highlighted her role in the party and considered the Jamaat-e-Islami to be '*[a] good party to give Islamic rules for Islamic state*', but the same person also recognized that '*I am not interested in political activities too much because work of political parties to give garbage on one another*' (Student, Female, Kasur).

In another case in a private university, one student admitted that she would consider getting involved in politics, but was already convinced that she would not be able to 'make a difference' for the simple reason that she did not have enough money to succeed at politics. '*I would but it wouldn't make a difference. There is lack of sincerity. You need a big car, big house and lots of money to succeed in politics. I will not survive*'; '*You can't be an honest person as a politician in Pakistan*' (Focus Group, Private University[41]). Another student mentioned how she had been politically active online by engaging in discussion forums related to politics on social media, but she stopped after the murder of Sabeen Mahmud, the political activist who was murdered on the night she hosted Baloch activist Mama Qadeer's talk on 'The Missing Baloch'. While her